

Kerry Hanson

Senior UX Designer

📞 612.280.5320 | ✉️ kerryhanson@gmail.com | 🔗 LinkedIn | 🌐 Portfolio

SUMMARY

Enterprise UX Designer with 6+ years of experience leading UX strategy, user research, and product design for complex enterprise platforms. Building on 20+ years of web, mobile, and product design across industries. Proven success delivering scalable, user-centered solutions that improve operational efficiency, product quality, and user experience through evidence-based design, systems thinking, and cross-functional collaboration.

Passionate about modernizing UX practice through AI-enabled workflows that accelerate research, prototyping, and design validation while maintaining a strong focus on accessibility, usability, and measurable business outcomes.

STRENGTHS

UX Leadership & Strategy: UX Strategy • Product Discovery • Design Thinking • Enterprise Product Design • Cross-functional Leadership • Stakeholder Facilitation • Design Operations

Research & Experience Design: User Research • Usability Testing • Information Architecture • Interaction Design • Wireframing • Prototyping • Journey Mapping • Accessibility (WCAG)

Design Systems & Product Delivery: Design Systems • UX Analysis • Product Strategy • AI-Enabled Design Workflows • HTML/CSS

Tools: Figma • FigJam • Dovetail • Cursor • ChatGPT • GitHub • Jira • Confluence • Miro • Supernova • Adobe CC

EXPERIENCE

Strategic Education, Inc. (Strayer University, Capella University) | Minneapolis, MN

UX Designer (Enterprise Platforms)

December 2023 – June 2026

- Led end-to-end UX for a greenfield enterprise curriculum platform—catalog discovery, curriculum authoring, and course management—replacing legacy workflows for 7+ schools, 50+ academic programs, and hundreds of internal users.
- Designed curriculum authoring and course management modules—including offering setup, competencies, duplication, and accreditation validations—validated with 30+ academic stakeholders through weekly Power User sessions before engineering handoff.
- Planned and facilitated multi-method research on Capella's FlexPath Competency Map and competency-based grading: 4 coach interviews, 138 learner survey responses, and CX support analytics (Qualtrics XM Discover)—synthesized into evidence-based product recommendations.
- Modernized UX practices by integrating AI into research synthesis, code-based prototyping, and MVP validation—reducing research synthesis time by 60% and design/prototyping time by 50%.
- Led evolution of the cross-brand Canvas course design system (Strayer, Capella, JWMI)—documented 14 components and patterns, audited 10 courses, trained 30+ learning technologists, and contributed to enterprise usability benchmarking.

Interactive Designer

July 2017 – December 2023

- Designed reusable interaction patterns, templates, and authoring workflows for a formative media platform producing 1000+ activities across FlexPath, Guided Path, and Strayer—quizzes, video, branching, card sorting, and more—with WCAG-compliant learner-facing components.
- Led learner usability testing across published activities—25 sessions spanning 5 studies (~4 per year)—informing feedback, navigation, and multi-page activity patterns used platform-wide.
- Led UX strategy and redesign for in-context learner feedback at activity completion—pilot response rates rose from ~0% to 10.3%, with 4/5 average satisfaction and 300+ qualitative responses in the first quarterly audit.
- Ensured WCAG compliance across interaction patterns and conducted UX/accessibility audits that improved consistency across digital learning products.
- Built wireframes, prototypes, and HTML/CSS for learner-facing activities and internal authoring workflows.

Robert Half, The Creative Group | Minneapolis, MN

UI/UX Designer

June 2016 – July 2017

Completed multiple contracts as part of Robert Half's Salaried Professional Services.

Thrivent Financial | Minneapolis, MN**Email Developer (Contract)**

October 2016 – November 2016

Developed responsive marketing email templates and landing pages in HubSpot for Thrivent's cuLearn program; built reusable email components and tested templates across email clients for rendering consistency and deliverability.

Christopher and Banks | Plymouth, MN**UI/Web Designer (Contract)**

June 2016 – September 2016

Designed and implemented UI updates for the e-commerce site in Demandware (Salesforce Commerce Cloud); produced HTML and CSS for category pages, promotional modules, and responsive layout updates.

Schwan's Food Company | Bloomington, MN**UX Designer (Contract)**

May 2016 – June 2016

Created wireframes and mockups to refine the e-commerce checkout flow and contributed UX recommendations on layout, step progression, and content hierarchy.

Colder Products Company (CPC) | Roseville, MN**Design and Production Artist**

August 2014 – August 2016

Designed and coded responsive HTML email templates and web/print assets for B2B marketing, product launches, and sales enablement in a regulated industrial environment.

Drebenstedt Consulting | St. Paul, MN**UI Designer**

August 2014 – August 2016

Designed UI for Angular-based web applications—from wireframes through visual design, HTML/CSS, and Angular templates for workflows, forms, and dashboard-style interfaces.

Accurate Image Marketing | Minneapolis, MN**UI Designer, Production, and Project Manager**

May 2000 – July 2015

Designed and maintained iOS, Android, and web applications for 30+ clients over 15 years; led end-to-end delivery as designer, production artist, and project manager including wireframes, prototypes, and HTML/CSS implementation.

EDUCATION**School of Communication Arts | Minneapolis, MN**

Associate of Applied Science, Multimedia/Graphic Design ·
1996 – 1998

CERTIFICATIONS**UX Certified (UXC)**

Nielsen Norman Group · 2021 · Specialization: UX Research